

Unit 2.2

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Amazon has developed a strong and highly active presence across multiple social media platforms, including Instagram, X, Facebook, and TikTok. The company uses these platforms to promote products, engage with customers, and reinforce its brand identity. Its approach aligns with many of the professional communication strategies outlined in Kolin (2022), particularly those discussed in Section 4.5b regarding effective social media practices.

One guideline Amazon clearly follows is maintaining consistent and engaging communication. The company regularly posts content that highlights new products, seasonal promotions, and customer-focused messaging. This reflects the principle of staying active and relevant on social media, which helps maintain audience interest and brand visibility (Kolin, 2022). Amazon also demonstrates strong audience awareness by tailoring content to different platforms. For example, its Instagram content is more visual and lifestyle-oriented, while its X accounts focuses on quick updates, customer service responses, and trending topics. This shows an understanding of how different audiences interact with content across platforms.

Another guideline Amazon follows is responsiveness. The company frequently replies to customer comments and concerns, especially on platforms like X. This aligns with the expectation that businesses should actively engage with their audience and provide timely communication. By doing so, Amazon strengthens customer relationships and builds trust. Additionally, Amazon maintains a generally professional tone in its message, which reflects the importance of clarity and credibility in workplace communication.

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However, Amazon does not fully follow every guideline outlined in Section 4.5b. One area where it falls short is personalization. While the company does respond to customers, many responses appear automated. This can make interactions feel less genuine and may limit deeper engagement. Another guideline that is not always followed is transparency. Amazon's social media content focuses heavily on promotion and branding, but it does not consistently address controversies or negative feedback in a visible way. This suggests a more controlled communication approach instead of open dialogue.

There seems to be a clear reason behind these choices. Amazon prioritizes efficiency, brand consistency, and large-scale communication over individualized interaction. Given the size of the company and the volume of customer interactions it manages daily, a more structured and less personalized approach allows it to maintain control over its messaging. This strategy supports its overall business model, which emphasizes speed, convenience, and scalability.

Overall, Amazon's social media presence reflects a strong understanding of effective digital communication practices. The company successfully follows key guidelines such as consistency, audience awareness, and responsiveness, while selectively aligned with Amazon's broader operational goals, demonstrating a strategic approach to social media communication.

References

Kolin, P.C. (2022). *Successful Writing at Work* (12th ed.). Cengage.